

Stage All Set for HIGH-DEFINITION TV

Currently, HDTV broadcast does not take place in India, but the scene is hotting up with broadcasters producing content for HDTV and consumer electronics companies offering HD TV sets and set-top boxes

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The highest form of digital television is all set to storm India. The greatest push has come from the government's announcement that DD (Doordarshan) will broadcast the Commonwealth Games in high-definition (HD) format. HDTV programming through cable/satellite also is coming to India very soon, as the film industry has geared into HD production.

For the end users, HDTV sets are already available in the market. Direct-to-home (DTH) TV operators

are trying to switch consumers at a premium for HDTV set-top boxes as INX Media and STAR TV are already producing content on HDTV. This is expected to take off by mid 2009. With so much of activity happening in this space, it is good time to dwell on the subject.

What is HDTV?

There are two modes of TV transmission: analogue and digital. Digital TV comes in standard, enhanced and high-definition formats. Standard has a resolution of 480i, enhanced is 480p, and high-definition is 720p, 1080i and 1080p. Therefore HDTV has the high-

est-level resolution offered within the digital TV category. We can also infer that HD is digital, but not all digital TV is HD. HDTV has a 16:9 aspect ratio, which is the same as that of a movie theatre screen.

HD resolution is listed in two different forms: "number of lines + type of scan" or "number of pixels" (vertical by horizontal).

Tarun Jain, country head-India, Hitachi Home Electronics, gives a breakdown of the HD formats listed by how manufacturers label them on their product summaries:

- 720p or 720×1280 - 720 lines, progressive scanned



HDTV LCD range by Samsung